Day 25 - Snows Creek, Reservoir, North Rim, Maureen Smith

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Toronto section · hike 34 · Scotsdale Farm and Silver Creek

11.3 km / 7.0 mi	~3.1 h	4.4 km new	49 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Scotsdale Farm: Enter from Trafalgar Rd, 1.7 km northwest of Highway 7. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day25_hike034.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Snows Creek Side Trail (2.1 km); Reservoir Side Trail (1.0 km); North Rim Side Trail (0.9 km); Maureen Smith Side Trail (0.4 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Scotsdale Farm, an Ontario Heritage Trust property; enter from Trafalgar Rd, 1.7 km northwest of Highway 7. Credit Valley Conservation notes there are no washrooms in the Silver Creek area and parking fills on weekends from 11 a.m. to 5 p.m.
- **Bennett Heritage Trail:** Starts at Scotsdale Farm and passes a pond with a weeping willow, then crosses Snow's Creek and Owl Creek. CVC rates it difficult.
- **Maureen Smith and Silver Creek side trails:** CVC rates both difficult. Maureen Smith has steep sections with rocks and boulders; the short Silver Creek Side Trail links it to the main Trail and crosses streams. The Maureen Smith Side Trail was lengthened in the July 2026 reconfiguration.
- **Main Trail:** Reworked in July 2026 onto a more natural route. CVC rates the Bruce Trail here strenuous, with escarpment views, wooden bridges and long steep climbs.
- **North Rim and Reservoir side trails:** The North Rim Side Trail (opened 2024) crosses an open, regenerating former quarry site. No description of the Reservoir Side Trail was found.
- **Snows Creek Side Trail:** Rebuilt as a 3.6 km side trail in July 2026 and leads back toward Scotsdale Farm. No published description of its terrain was found.
- **Older maps:** After the July 2026 Silver Creek reconfiguration, the Duff Pit, Trafalgar and Great Esker side trails no longer appear under those names; parts became main Trail or were renamed. Follow the current blazes and the guide's directions.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	In the laneway off the west side of Eighth Line where the Bennett Heritage Trail crosses map	Free	0.9	120 m	Maureen Smith
P3	Roadside parking across from the Eighth Line Side Trail on Eighth Line map	Free	3.3	1080 m	
P4	Roadside parking on the eastern shoulder of Eighth Line at the southernmost intersection with... map	Free	3.3	1340 m	
P5	Sixth Line parking (north), new July 2026 for the Silver Creek trail changes (BTC notice... map	Fee unclear	9.1	990 m	Snows Creek

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Scotsdale Farm: Enter from Trafalgar Rd, 1.7 km northwest of Highway 7. Walk about 50 m to the trail. Head north-east on the blue-blazed Bennett Heritage Trail.

0.9	0.6	J1: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Maureen Smith Side Trail, heading south-east. (the blue-blazed Bennett Heritage Trail goes off ahead.) There is trailhead parking here (In the laneway off the west side of Eighth Line where the Bennett Heritage Trail crosses).
1.2	0.7	Heads-up: The next 0.2 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
1.6	1.0	J2: Junction. Turn left to stay on the Maureen Smith Side Trail, heading south-east. (the blue-blazed Snows Creek Side Trail goes off ahead.)
3.4	2.1	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Silver Creek Side Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Maureen Smith Side Trail goes off on your left.)
4.0	2.5	J4: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
4.7	2.9	J5: Turn right onto the blue-blazed North Rim Side Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
5.6	3.5	J6: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-east. (the blue-blazed Snows Creek Side Trail goes off on your right; the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
6.4	4.0	J7: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Reservoir Side Trail, heading south-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.) This is a short excursion (about 1160 m in all): walk the whole Reservoir Side Trail, including the short loop or branch near its end (see the map), and come back to this junction.
7.5	4.7	J7: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
8.3	5.1	J6: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Snows Creek Side Trail, heading west. (the North Rim Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right; the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
8.9	5.5	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
10.3	6.4	J8: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Bennett Heritage Trail, heading north-west. (the blue-blazed Snows Creek Side Trail goes off on your right.)
11.3	7.0	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Credit Valley Conservation, Bruce Trail Conservancy trail-change notices and Ontario Nature Trails.